

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1220

By McKenzie

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Juanita Usher Cannon of Knoxville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Juanita Usher Cannon of Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, a dedicated educator and community leader, Juanita Cannon was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, a 1958 graduate of Austin High School, Ms. Cannon earned degrees from Knoxville College and the University of Tennessee, Knoxville; she was a member of Alpha Kappa Alpha Sorority, Inc., and in 2011, she was named a Golden Soror in honor of fifty years of active membership within the organization; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Cannon was a professional educator of nearly forty years and always sought the best for her students and her community; she cared deeply for her students and was known for expressing her compassion, showing respect, and building relationships with her colleagues and students; and

WHEREAS, Juanita Cannon was proud to teach at Austin-East Magnet High School from 1969 to 1989; during that time, she taught health, physical education, and tap dancing, and she coached volleyball and cheer; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Cannon became principal of Vine Middle Magnet School in 1994 and further served her community as principal of the Transition School and vice principal of Spring Hill and Holston middle schools; and

WHEREAS, a renowned leader in her community and her profession, Juanita Cannon was the first African-American president of the Knoxville Education Association and served as a member of the Tennessee Education Association board of directors; and

WHEREAS, she was a member of Knoxville's Community Development Corporation for eighteen years; her work with the board, which ended in 2012, included service as chair and redeveloping Mechanicsville through the Hope VI project; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and recognition, Ms. Cannon was the recipient of the Dewey W. Roberts human relations award; in 2013, a street near Paul Hogue Park was named in her honor, a most befitting recognition that celebrates her civic service and years of community involvement; and

WHEREAS, Juanita Cannon was also wholly devoted to her faith and was an active member of Mount Olive Baptist Church; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Cannon lived her life filled with love and selfless service, and she greatly impacted the lives of those who were blessed to know her with her guidance and mentorship; and

WHEREAS, Juanita Cannon leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Juanita Usher Cannon, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.